

3 Work

Speaking 1: talking about work

- A** Look at the four photos and think about the kind of work that the people are doing. Think for one minute about what you want to say about each photo.



- B** Work in pairs. Take turns to choose a photo and talk about it. Try to talk for about one minute about each. Use phrases from the box.

This picture shows people ... ing. These people work in / on / for ...
 This is a good job because ... I would / wouldn't like to do this job because ...
 This job is easy / difficult / interesting / boring because ...

Vocabulary 1: jobs and saying what you do

- A** Listen and write the job names. Be careful with your spelling.

1. accountant 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____
 5. _____ 6. _____ 7. _____ 8. _____

- B** Listen again and mark the main stress on each word.

- C** Circle the correct preposition in each sentence.

1. I work for / as an architect.
2. I work for / as an oil company.
3. I work at / in the fashion industry.
4. I work in / on an office.
5. I work with / by computers.

- D** Talk about your job or the job you want to do using the structures in Exercise C.



Exam tip: The examiner will probably ask you about work. Practise saying in different ways what you do or would like to do. Use a dictionary to find specialist words, but check with somebody that you are using the words properly.

E Check the highlighted words and mark each sentence (P) positive or (N) negative.

1. I think my job is very **interesting**. P
2. It's a very **boring** job. It's too easy and I don't meet anyone. —
3. It's very **rewarding**. I can go home knowing I've really helped somebody. —
4. My job is **challenging**. I have to think quickly sometimes. Not everyone could do it. —
5. My job is a bit **repetitive**. Every day is the same as the day before. —
6. It's too **stressful**. My doctor told me to find another job soon. —

Watch out! typical errors

I'm engineer. **X**
I have a good work. **X**
Work is uncountable – job is countable.

F Cover Exercise E and write the six adjectives in your notebook. Check your spelling.

Speaking 2: talking about jobs

A Answer these questions with a partner.

1. What jobs do the people in your family do?
2. Do any of your friends or family have a job you would really like?
3. Is there a job you would like to do more than any other?

Grammar check

We use *would* and *could* when a situation is not real.

What job would you most like? (the person will not really have this job)

Do you think you could do his job? (the person will not really try to do the job)

Watch out! typical errors

Do you like to work in another country. **X**
Do you think you can be the president of your country one day? **X**

Pronunciation check

 Listen and notice the pronunciation of *would you* /wʊdʒu:/ and *could you* /kʊdʒu:/. Practise saying the sentences.

1. What job would you most like?
2. Do you think you could do this job?



Exam tip: In the second part of the Speaking Module, you have to talk about a topic for about two minutes. The examiner will give you a card with the topic and some points to think about. You have a minute to prepare and write notes. You can ask the examiner about anything that you don't understand.

B Here are two typical cards for part 2 of the Speaking Module. Work with a partner – one of you is A, the other is B. Think about the topic for a minute and make notes.

A

Describe a job you think is really difficult.

Say ...

- what the job is.
- why it is difficult.
- why some people do it.
- why you wouldn't like to do it.

B

What is the best job in the world? Say ...

- what the job is.
- why it is such a good job.
- what type of person does it.
- if you think you could do it.

C Take turns to speak about what's on your card for about two minutes.

Listening

3

Listening 1: listening for gist

A Look at the pictures. Talk to a partner about what is happening in each.

B Listen to the four extracts and match them with the pictures. Write the number of the extract in the box.



C With a partner, discuss how you completed the task. Answer these questions.

1. Did you use the pictures to get ideas to listen for?
2. Did the speakers' voices (stress and intonation) help?
3. Did you hear any key words or phrases that helped?

D Read this short text about listening skills and fill the gaps with the words below.

word details topic skimming

When you listen for gist, you listen to understand the general (1) _____ of the dialogue or conversation (the situation and what the people are talking about). You are not listening for specific (2) _____ and you don't need to understand every (3) _____. If you understand the gist of a conversation, it will be easier to understand the details if necessary. Listening for gist is similar to (4) _____ a text when you read.



Exam tip: When you listen for gist, predicting what you will hear is very important. In the exam, you will not have photos, but a map, a diagram or a table will help you predict. You can also predict by looking at the questions and noticing key words and phrases.

E Look at the four images below. You will hear a short extract for each. What can you predict about each extract?



F Listen to the four extracts and match them with the images in Exercise E.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Listening 2: practise listening for gist



Exam tip: Sometimes you will need to listen for gist rather than for specific information. But remember – understanding gist will help you understand details, too.

A

Listen to the four extracts. For questions 1–4, match the extracts with the pictures. Write the number of the extract in the box.



Read through the questions. Then listen to the extracts again. For questions 5–12, choose the correct answer a, b or c.

Extract 1

- | | | |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| 5. Toby has come to the office ... | 6. It is Toby's ... | 7. Keith is ... |
| a. for an interview. | a. first visit. | a. Julie's boss. |
| b. to start work. | b. second visit. | b. Julie's assistant. |
| c. to prepare for a new job. | c. third or fourth visit. | c. an important customer. |

Extract 2

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| 8. The man is talking about ... | 9. The man speaking knows that ... |
| a. a new building. | a. everyone will drive to work. |
| b. his garden. | b. everyone will cycle to work. |
| c. a design for a car. | c. some people will drive and others cycle. |

Extract 3

10. Debbie is phoning Robert to ...
- give him good news.
 - tell him there is a problem.
 - arrange a meeting.

Extract 4

- | | |
|----------------------------|---|
| 11. The man is selling ... | 12. The woman ... |
| a. products for the home. | a. is very interested. |
| b. books. | b. is not at all interested. |
| c. new kitchens. | c. doesn't understand what the man wants. |

B

Check the key on page 266. How many questions did you answer correctly?

C

Tick the sentences about the listening task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

- The pictures helped me to make predictions about each topic.
- It was quite easy to match the pictures to the extracts.
- I didn't understand all the words in the questions.
- Understanding the gist helped me to understand detail.
- I am pleased with how many of questions 5–12 I answered correctly.

Key vocabulary in context

Match the words and phrases from listening task 1–4 with definitions a–d.

- | | |
|-------------|---|
| 1. design | a. what a company makes to sell |
| 2. staff | b. a person who buys something |
| 3. customer | c. all the people who work for a company |
| 4. product | d. a drawing that shows what something will look like |

Reading 1: scanning for paraphrased language



Exam tip: In the second part of the Reading Module, the texts will always be related to work. You might read a job application or a page of staff rules, for example.

A Look at the photos. Answer these questions with a partner.

1. What is each job?
2. What is good and not so good about each job?
3. Would you like to do any of the jobs?



B Use a dictionary to check these words and then match each with one of the photos.

- a. farms ____ b. flights ____ c. pitch ____ d. tips ____

C Read the title of the passage on the next page. Will each person say good things or bad things about the job?



Exam tip: Always read the heading or title of a passage. It will help you predict what it is about.

D Read the four short texts and circle the job in each as quickly as possible.

E Scan the four texts and use the highlighted parts to answer these questions. Write the letter of the text in the space. In which text does the writer say that ...

1. he or she was very tired? ____
2. he or she got a lot of money from the job? ____
3. he or she got no money for doing the job? ____
4. he or she had free time to enjoy? ____



Exam tip: In some scanning exercises, you need to look quickly for parts of the text that mean the same as the words and phrases in the question. You will not find the exact words and phrases from the question in the text.

F Scan the text again to answer these questions in the same way. Highlight the parts of the text that provide the answer. In which text does the writer say that ...

1. he or she enjoyed working outside. ____
2. he or she met famous people. ____
3. he or she doesn't do the job now. ____
4. people don't think the job is interesting. ____

The Best Job I Ever Had

Text A

I had the best job in the world for three years and I didn't even get paid for it. From when I was 12 until when I was 15, I was a ball boy at Old Trafford. That's where Manchester United play their home matches. When the ball went off the pitch, I had to get it and give it back to one of the players as quickly as I could. I saw some great football matches and met footballers and football coaches from all round the world.

Text B

People think that being a waitress is boring and repetitive, but it's the best job I ever had. I worked in a very nice restaurant where all the customers had plenty of money. The restaurant didn't pay me very much, but I made a fortune from the huge tips that the customers gave me. I always did my job well because I knew that if the customers weren't happy, they wouldn't give me a tip.

Text C

The job I'm doing now pays very well, but it's quite boring and very stressful. I think I was happiest when I was picking fruit in France. My friends and I were students, and we travelled around France working on farms. We picked grapes and strawberries. We worked very long hours, and at the end of the day I was exhausted, but I was in the sunshine all day and I was working with the people I knew best.

Text D

These days, I stay at home and look after my two children, but for ten years I had the best job in the world. I was an air hostess working on international flights. I flew to Australia and South America. During the flights, I was very busy and the passengers were sometimes quite difficult, but I got three days off before the journey back. The airline put me in the best hotels and I had a great time. I saw some wonderful places in those ten years.

Reading 2: practise scanning for paraphrased language

A Look at the job titles in the advertisements on the next page and check that you understand them.

B Read the job advertisements and answer the questions. For questions 1–3, match each job advertisement with a description a–d. Write the letter of the description in the space. There is one description that you do not need.

1. advert A ____ 2. advert B ____ 3. advert C ____

- a. You will deal with people who want to buy or who have already bought a product.
b. You will sell something.
c. You will design something.
d. You will work with money.

For questions 4–9, write the letter of the advertisement in the space.
Which advertisement says that ...

4. you must know how to use a computer. ____
5. you will work closely with someone in a high position. ____
6. you will learn how to do the job when you start. ____
7. people are happy with the service provided by the company. ____
8. you will often talk to people directly. ____
9. you need to apply before a certain date. ____



Exam tip: When you are doing a reading exercise quickly, you might want to guess answers, and sometimes that's possible. However, you will feel more confident if you find the part of the text that provides the answer.

A

**ACCOUNTS DIRECTOR /
FINANCIAL MANAGER**

Up to £70,000 a year + company car.

A position managing our financial services and working directly with the chief executive. You should be a qualified accountant with experience in management.

Closing date for application: 11 March 09**Interviews:** April 09

B

Our market is growing and we are looking for a:

SALES EXECUTIVE

As part of our busy sales team, you will be ambitious. You will deal face-to-face with people regularly and must have excellent communication skills. You will be quick to understand new ideas and put them into practice.

You will receive full training and a good salary.
For more information, please call 01456 554796.

C

Customer Service Administrator

Lewes, East Sussex

Good salary + benefits

We have more than a million satisfied customers in the UK, and we provide the highest quality service. To continue our success, we are looking for a full-time customer service administrator.

The successful applicant must have previous experience and be computer-literate.

He or she will need a friendly, professional telephone manner.

To apply, please send your CV to Sonya_Groves@Sureguard.co.uk

C Highlight the parts of the adverts that give the answers to questions 4–9. Then compare your ideas with a partner.

D Check the key on page 266. How many questions did you answer correctly?

E Tick the sentences about the reading task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

1. I read the instructions for the questions carefully.
2. I skimmed the advertisements to answer questions 1–3.
3. I answered questions 1–3 quickly.
4. I read more carefully to answer questions 4–9.
5. It was quite easy to find the information I needed for questions 4–9.
6. I am happy with how many questions I answered correctly.

Key vocabulary in context

Circle the correct word from the three options. You can find the correct options in the job adverts.

1. A more formal word for job is *position* / *protection* / *preparation*.
2. If you do a job for a long time, you have *experiment* / *experience* / *expression*.
3. If you want to do well in a job, you are *ambitious* / *amazing* / *absent*.
4. Another way to say 'give' a service is *prove* / *produce* / *provide*.
5. If a company is doing well, it has *surprise* / *success* / *support*.

F Highlight words and phrases in the adverts that you think are useful.



Exam tip: It is not possible to learn all the new vocabulary from a text that you read, and usually it is not very helpful to try. Focus on words and phrases that are useful to you.

WB For more focus on reading skills, go to Workbook page 10.

Writing 1: register

A Discuss with a partner. Which definition of register is correct?

1. *Register* is planning and organizing your writing.
2. *Register* is spelling words correctly and using punctuation.
3. *Register* is making sure that what you write is grammatically correct.
4. *Register* is using the right words and phrases for the situation – using words and phrases that are formal or informal.

B Mark the following types of letter (VF) very formal, (QF) quite formal or (INF) informal.

1. an e-mail to a friend telling him about a party you are having _____
2. a letter to a tour operator complaining about a holiday _____
3. a letter to a family in Britain that you are going to stay with _____
4. a letter to a college asking for information about a course _____
5. a letter to your cousin thanking him for a present _____
6. a letter to a friend apologizing because you cannot go to his wedding _____
7. a letter that you send with your CV when applying for a job _____



Exam tip: The letter that you write for the first part of the Writing Module will probably be formal. You might have to write a more personal letter, but it will not be very informal.

C Match the formal expressions 1–8 with the informal expressions A–H.

1 Dear Sir / Madam

2 I am writing to inform you that ...

3 I will not be able to attend the ...

4 Could you send the information to my home address?

5 I look forward to hearing from you.

6 Thank you once again for your advice.

7 I apologize for the inconvenience.

8 Yours faithfully / sincerely

A Sorry for any trouble I caused.

B Let me have all the info a.s.a.p.

C Can't wait to hear all about it!

D Best wishes

E I wanted to tell you about ...

F Hi Phil, how's it going?

G I can't make it to ...

H ... and thanks again for all your help.



Exam tip: Almost anything can be expressed formally or informally. You need to learn the most common words and expressions that are used in certain types of composition.

Writing 2: a letter of application

A Talk to a partner. Look again at advert B on page 40. What type of person is the company looking for?

B Read the cover letter that Ahmed sent with his CV. Do you think he would be suitable for the position?



Dear Mr Lucas,

I am writing to get the position of sales executive that I saw advertised in yesterday's *Daily Argus*. I want a job in sales, and I am interested in working for your company.

I recently finished a Business Studies degree at York University. I did very well in Economics and Marketing. Part of my degree course was about designing and developing new ideas. I learn quickly and work well with other people.

My father runs an import and export company, and from the age of 16 I have helped him in his office. I have learnt a lot about business and communicated with clients both on the telephone and face-to-face.

I am outgoing and confident and I enjoy a challenge. I think I would be the right person for a position in your company. I can attend an interview at any time and really want to hear from you.

Yours sincerely,

Ahmed Khatani

C Below are some tips on how to organize an application letter. Write the number of each tip in the boxes on the letter.

1. Say that you are qualified for the job – mention education and experience.
2. Say where you saw the job advertised.
3. Say something about your personal qualities.
4. State your purpose for writing.
5. Close the letter in a polite, positive way.

D Some words and phrases in the letter are underlined because they are too informal. Replace them with the words and phrases below.

look forward to hearing	apply for	involved	hope to work
achieved very high grades		many useful business skills	

E Read the complete model letter on page 267 and check your answers. Does it sound better than Ahmed's first letter?

WB Go to Workbook page 11 for the writing task.

Speaking

A Work with a partner. Discuss this advice about the second part of the IELTS Speaking Module. Tick the correct advice A or B.

1. **A** The examiner will give you some pictures to talk about.
B The examiner will give you a card to read.
2. **A** Don't worry if you don't understand words or phrases on the card.
B You can ask the examiner about words and phrases that you don't know.
3. **A** You should try to talk about each of the points on the card.
B You can talk about whatever you like.
4. **A** You should try to use a range of words and phrases.
B You must use advanced vocabulary.
5. **A** The examiner will listen for grammatical mistakes.
B It doesn't matter if you make grammatical mistakes.
6. **A** You will score a higher grade if your pronunciation is clear.
B Your pronunciation must be perfect.

B Look at this card for part 2 of the Speaking Module. Are there any words you don't know?

C  Listen to a student doing the exam. Which words does he check? Highlight them on the card.

D  Look at the tapescript and listen again. Notice how the student asked questions and how the examiner answered.

What is the best job in the world?
Say ...

- what the job is.
- what personal qualities you need.
- what is so appealing about the job.

E Practise answering the question. Try to talk for about a minute.

Vocabulary

A Match a word on the left with a word on the right to make six common two-part expressions.

past	applicant	1.	_____
computer	qualities	2.	_____
long	executive	3.	_____
personal	hours	4.	_____
successful	experience	5.	_____
chief	literate	6.	_____

B  Listen and write these words from the unit in your notebook. Check your spelling. Then mark the main stress on each word.

Errors

A There are errors in all of these sentences (sometimes there is more than one). Correct them.

1. I work at an engineer.
2. I work with the food industry.
3. I think I have a really good work.
4. I get good salary.
5. Do you like work in another country one day?
6. I will meet the other staffs tomorrow.
7. I saw advertisement in the evening star.
8. I might apply to this job. It looks interesting.

Exam Practice

3

Listening

- A** You will hear three people talking about working from home. Before you listen, talk to a partner. What are some of the good things and bad things about working from home?



Exam tip: In the Listening Module, you will not have a picture and you will not be able to talk about the situation before you listen. But you will have time to look at the questions and should predict as much as you can.

- B** Look through the questions carefully. Then listen and answer the questions.

For questions 1 and 2, choose the correct answer a, b or c.

1. Simon started working from home because ...
 - a. he wanted to.
 - b. his company wanted him to.
 - c. his family wanted him to.
2. Why are Simon's company happy for him to work from home?
 - a. They can pay less money.
 - b. Now they can move to a smaller office.
 - c. The main office is too small.



Question-type tip: Sometimes you need to choose a number of answers from a larger number of options.

For questions 3–8, choose six answers from A–J. Which of these points do the speakers mention when they talk about working from home?

- A People in the office sometimes stop you working.
- B You always do more work when you are at home.
- C At home, you sometimes start work later than you planned.
- D It's easy to waste time watching TV.
- E Your family don't always let you do your work.
- F Most people wear a suit when they work from home.
- G You don't need to look smart when you work from home.
- H There are more technical problems with computers.
- I Not seeing other people all day can be difficult.
- J You get a lot of phone calls when you work from home.

3. ____ 4. ____ 5. ____ 6. ____ 7. ____ 8. ____

Reading

A Read the passage and answer the questions. For questions 1–8, write the letter of the text in the space. In which text does the writer say that ...

1. it was very hot. _____
2. it was sometimes very cold. _____
3. he or she worked with somebody he or she didn't like. _____
4. he or she started work very early. _____
5. he or she did not get much money for doing the job. _____
6. he or she left the job suddenly. _____
7. time went very slowly. _____
8. some parts of the job were worse than others. _____

For questions 9–12, complete the notes with words from the passage. Write no more than two words or a number for each answer.



Question-type tip: In the Reading and Listening Modules, you will sometimes need to complete notes with words from the text. The instructions will tell you how many words you can use.

9. In text A, the writer bought a bicycle with the money that he or she _____.
10. In text B, the writer spent all day looking forward to going _____.
11. In text C, the writer says that the restaurant _____ as the evening went on.
12. In text D, the writer says that if he or she _____, his or her boss complained.

The Worst Job I Ever Had

Text A

I think the worst job I ever had was when I was about 14. I had to deliver newspapers before I went to school. I had to be at the shop by about 6.30 a.m. and then, when the round was finished, I went home for breakfast. I remember icy winter mornings when all I wanted to do was stay in bed. At the beginning of the round, when the bag was full of newspapers, it was really heavy. I did it for about two years and I saved enough money to buy a bicycle.

Text B

When I was at school taking my A levels, I worked all day Saturday on the checkout at the local supermarket. It was really boring and really repetitive, and when I think about it now, not very well paid at all. I remember looking at the clock on the wall and thinking that the hands weren't moving. The customers were mostly friendly, but all I wanted was to finish and go home.

Text C

When I was a student, I washed up in the kitchen of a big restaurant. The heat in the kitchen was terrible, and it was always so noisy. It was definitely the most horrible job I have ever done. At the beginning of the evening, it wasn't too bad, but as the restaurant became busier the work started to pile up. Washing plates and dishes was quite easy, but cleaning the pots and pans that were used to cook in was impossible.

Text D

I was really unhappy when I worked as a secretary for a company in Liverpool. The job itself wasn't so bad, but my boss was really unfriendly and he seemed to enjoy making life difficult for me. He complained if I was two or three minutes late, but always gave me something to do just before it was time to go home. One day, I decided that I had had enough, and I just walked out of the office and never went back.